

# *The Garden Party*

Katherine Mansfield · 1922

First published: Westminster Gazette, Feb 1922

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC

*Cover: Claude Monet, Springtime (1872). Public domain (Wikimedia Commons).*

# Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
4. Whole-book test and answer key
5. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

**Edition:** Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/The_Garden_Party,_and_Other_Stories/The_Garden-Party (revision 14693900), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

**Grades:** Grades 10–12 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). Middle School prompts use the full text when the grade tags include 6–8; otherwise teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 1 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

## Essential questions

- What does The Garden Party suggest about class and privilege?
- What does The Garden Party suggest about life and death?
- What does The Garden Party suggest about coming of age?

## Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the story.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

## Standards and frameworks

- **Common Core:** RL.7.2, RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.7.1, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4
  Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org
- **Indiana 2023:** 7.RC.2, 7.RC.3, 7.W.1, 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.RC.11, 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1
  Indiana Academic Standards, English/Language Arts (2023), IDOE

- **Dual Credit (Indiana College Core):** ICC-WC-1.1, ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.7
  Indiana College Core, Written Communication outcomes 1.1–1.7 (CHE guidance); ICC-WC-x IDs are ours
- **AP:** AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.SET, AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN
  AP English Literature and Composition big ideas (our summaries; apcentral.collegeboard.org)
- **Cambridge International:** CAIE-9695.AO1, CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4, CAIE-9695.AO5
  Cambridge International AS & A Level Literature in English 9695 assessment objectives (our summaries; cambridgeinternational.org)
- **Liber et Libri program outcomes:** LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1
  Liber et Libri program outcome, not an official standard

**Primary codes:** RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, RL.7.2
**Assessments:** Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
**Differentiation:** Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
**Materials:** Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

## The 90-minute lesson

| # | Segment | Mode | Minutes | Clock |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Bell-ringer | You do | 8 | 0–8 |
| 2 | Vocabulary with etymology notes | I do | 10 | 8–18 |
| 3 | Background and context | I do | 10 | 18–28 |
| 4 | I do: modeled close reading | I do | 12 | 28–40 |
| 5 | We do: guided annotation | We do | 15 | 40–55 |
| 6 | You do: independent annotation | You do | 15 | 55–70 |
| 7 | Discussion | We do | 10 | 70–80 |
| 8 | Exit ticket / chapter quiz | You do | 7 | 80–87 |
| 9 | Closure | I do | 3 | 87–90 |
| | **Total** | | **90** | |

# Syllabus

| Week | Chapters | Lessons | Focus and activities | Assessment |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | The Garden Party | 1 × 90 min (90 min) | *class and privilege*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Story quizzes in the app<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |

# Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

## Lesson 1: The Garden Party

**Focus:** a girl's first encounter with death across the class line

**Content note (death of a working man, viewing a body):** Sensitive content: Death of a working man; viewing a body. Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail.
**Student preview:** Heads-up: this story includes death of a working man; viewing a body.
**Suggested language:** "Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

The wealthy Sheridans prepare a garden party. Laura learns that a young carter from the poor cottages below, Scott, has been killed, and wants to cancel; her mother and sister refuse. After the party, Laura takes a basket of leftovers to the widow and is led to see the dead man, who looks peaceful and beautiful. She apologizes for her hat and, sobbing, tries to tell her brother Laurie what life is.

**Background:** Published in 1922 in the Westminster Gazette; Mansfield drew on her childhood in Wellington, New Zealand.

**Significance:** A modernist story of free indirect discourse and epiphany.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Settle in and write for five minutes: Should a happy event go on when something sad happens nearby? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: Heads-up: this story includes death of a working man; viewing a body.*

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
*Today's words are eyesore, meaningly, supervise, ripened, crouched. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "They were the greatest possible eyesore, and they had no right to be in that neighbourhood at all." In this sentence it means: something ugly that spoils a view. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Present the historical and literary background.
*Here is what the first readers of The Garden Party would have known. Published in 1922 in the Westminster Gazette; Mansfield drew on her childhood in Wellington, New Zealand. Why does this story matter? A modernist story of free indirect discourse and epiphany. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for point of view.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "And after all the weather was ideal." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? I circle "visited", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find point of view, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for point of view.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of point of view. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *And after all the weather was ideal. They could not have had a more perfect day for a garden-party if they had ordered it. Windless, warm, the sky without a cloud. Only the blue was veiled with a haze of light gold, as it is sometimes in early summer. The gardener had been up since dawn, mowing the lawns and sweeping them, until the grass and the dark flat rosettes where the daisy plants had been seemed to shine. As for the roses, you could not help feeling they understood that roses are the only flowers that impress people at garden-parties; the only flowers that everybody is certain of knowing. Hundreds, yes, literally hundreds, had come out in a single night; the green bushes bowed down as though they had been visited by archangels.*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Point of view, Imagery, Irony: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how The Garden Party develops the idea of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this story connect to class and privilege? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Story quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the story quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this story suggests about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how point of view shapes a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Tonight, read the next story and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **eyesore** (noun) | something ugly that spoils a view | *They were the greatest possible eyesore, and they had no right to be in that neighbourhood at all.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **meaningly** (adverb) | in a way meant to suggest something unspoken | *She said meaningly, "I'm'er sister, miss.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **supervise** (verb) | to watch over and direct work | *But Meg could not possibly go and supervise the men.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ripened** (verb) | cause to ripen or develop fully | *And the perfect afternoon slowly ripened, slowly faded, slowly its petals closed.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **crouched** (verb) | bend one's back forward from the waist on down | *She crouched down as if to warm herself at that blaze of lilies; she felt they were in her fingers, on her lips, growing in her breast.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **agreeing** (verb) | be in accord; be in agreement | *All the same, they couldn't help agreeing that the puffs looked very attractive.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **arranging** (verb) | put into a proper or systematic order | *Cook began arranging them, shaking off the extra icing sugar.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **newspaper** (noun) | a daily or weekly publication on folded sheets; contains news and articles and advertisements | *But it all seemed blurred, unreal, like a picture in the newspaper.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **visited** (verb) | called on (someone) | *Hundreds, yes, literally hundreds, had come out in a single night; the green bushes bowed down as though they had been visited by archangels.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Should a happy event go on when something sad happens nearby?
2. Where does point of view appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.

3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with class and privilege?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What are the Sheridans preparing? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A garden party
2. Who has died? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A young carter, Mr. Scott
3. What does Laura want to do when she hears the news? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Stop the party
4. What does Mrs. Sheridan give Laura to take? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A basket of leftover food
5. What does Laura say to the dead man? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Forgive my hat
6. Retell the three most important events of “The Garden Party” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: The wealthy Sheridans prepare a garden party. Laura learns that a young carter from the poor cottages below, Scott, has been killed, and wants to cancel; her mother and sister refuse. After the party, Laura takes a basket of leftovers to the widow and is led to see the dead man, who looks peaceful and beautiful. She apologizes for her hat and, sobbing, tries to tell her brother Laurie what life…
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “The Garden Party”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “The Garden Party” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: “They were the greatest possible eyesore, and they had no right to be in that neighbourhood at all.” What does “eyesore” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: eyesore: something ugly that spoils a view.
10. Reread: “She said meaningly, ‘I’m’er sister, miss.” What does “meaningly” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: meaningly: in a way meant to suggest something unspoken.

#### Inferential / analytical

1. What does “The Garden Party” suggest about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A modernist story of free indirect discourse and epiphany.

2. Find one example of point of view in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
3. How does the imagery in this story shape what we understand about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. In the passage that begins “And after all the weather was ideal.”, why might Mansfield have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “The Garden Party”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: The wealthy Sheridans prepare a garden party. Laura learns that a young carter from the poor cottages below, Scott, has been killed, and wants to cancel; her mother and sister refuse. After the party, Laura takes a basket of leftovers to the widow and is led to see the dead man, who looks peaceful…
6. As the opening story, what does “The Garden Party” set up that the rest of The Garden Party will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Should a happy event go on when something sad happens nearby?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with class and privilege? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
10. Background: Published in 1922 in the Westminster Gazette; Mansfield drew on her childhood in Wellington, New Zealand. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. A critic might argue: “A modernist story of free indirect discourse and epiphany.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
3. Rewrite one moment of “The Garden Party” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

4. Write three questions of your own about “The Garden Party”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
5. Connect this story to life and death: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Mansfield need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
6. Is the point of view in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
7. Compare how “The Garden Party” treats a girl's first encounter with death across the class line with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Garden Party see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
8. As the final story, does this ending resolve class and privilege? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
10. What question would you most like to ask Katherine Mansfield about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What are the Sheridans preparing?
   A. A dance at a hotel
   B. A garden party
   C. A funeral
   D. A wedding
2. Who has died?
   A. A young carter, Mr. Scott
   B. A neighbor's child
   C. A gardener
   D. Laura's father
3. What does Laura want to do when she hears the news?
   A. Tell Laurie
   B. Visit the cottage at once

C. Hide

D. Stop the party

4. What does Mrs. Sheridan give Laura to take?

A. Her hat

B. Money

C. A basket of leftover food

D. Flowers

5. What does Laura say to the dead man?

A. Rest well

B. I am sorry you died

C. Forgive my hat

D. Goodbye

6. In the line “They were the greatest possible eyesore, and they had no right to be in that neighbourhood at all.”, what does “eyesore” most nearly mean?

A. to watch over and direct work

B. something ugly that spoils a view

C. in a way meant to suggest something unspoken

D. cause to ripen or develop fully

7. In the line “She said meaningly, “I’m’er sister, miss.”, what does “meaningly” most nearly mean?

A. to watch over and direct work

B. something ugly that spoils a view

C. in a way meant to suggest something unspoken

D. cause to ripen or develop fully

**Answer key:** 1. B (A garden party); 2. A (A young carter, Mr. Scott); 3. D (Stop the party); 4. C (A basket of leftover food); 5. C (Forgive my hat); 6. B (something ugly that spoils a view); 7. C (in a way meant to suggest something unspoken)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this story is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Garden Party,” how does Mansfield show a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In The Garden Party, how does Mansfield develop the idea of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the story helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how The Garden Party develops the idea of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of The Garden Party (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what The Garden Party suggests about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's point of view and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Katherine Mansfield uses point of view in The Garden Party to complicate the reader's understanding of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate The Garden Party within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read The Garden Party alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Garden Party and its treatment of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's point of view and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads The Garden Party as evidence for a larger claim about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line in The Garden Party. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads The Garden Party as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of a girl's first

encounter with death across the class line. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Garden Party.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *But Meg could not possibly go and supervise the men.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "supervise" most nearly mean?

   A. to watch over and direct work

   B. put into a proper or systematic order

   C. a daily or weekly publication on folded sheets; contains news and articles and advertisements

   D. called on (someone)

2. *And after all the weather was ideal. They could not have had a more perfect day for a garden-party if they had ordered it. Windless, warm, the sky without a cloud. Only the blue was veiled with a haze of light gold, as it is sometimes in early summer. The gardener had been up since dawn, mowing the lawns and sweeping them, until the grass and the dark flat rosettes where the daisy plants had been seemed to shine. As for the roses, you could not help feeling they understood that roses are the only flowers that impress people at garden-parties; the only flowers that everybody is certain of knowing. Hundreds, yes, literally hundreds, had come out in a single night; the green bushes bowed down as though they had been visited by archangels.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "The Garden Party"?

   A. Courage in defense of home

   B. Endurance turning to justice

   C. A girl's first encounter with death across the class line

   D. Racial pride destroying love

**SAT key:** 1. A (to watch over and direct work); 2. C (A girl's first encounter with death across the class line)

# Whole-book test

**The Garden Party: whole-book test** · 90 minutes

## Part I: Multiple choice

1. What are the Sheridans preparing?
   A. A dance at a hotel
   B. A garden party
   C. A funeral
   D. A wedding
2. Who has died?
   A. A young carter, Mr. Scott
   B. A neighbor's child
   C. A gardener
   D. Laura's father
3. What does Laura want to do when she hears the news?
   A. Tell Laurie
   B. Visit the cottage at once
   C. Hide
   D. Stop the party
4. What does Mrs. Sheridan give Laura to take?
   A. Her hat
   B. Money
   C. A basket of leftover food
   D. Flowers
5. What does Laura say to the dead man?
   A. Rest well
   B. I am sorry you died
   C. Forgive my hat
   D. Goodbye
6. In the line “They were the greatest possible eyesore, and they had no right to be in that neighbourhood at all.”, what does “eyesore” most nearly mean?
   A. to watch over and direct work
   B. something ugly that spoils a view
   C. in a way meant to suggest something unspoken
   D. cause to ripen or develop fully

7. In the line “She said meaningly, “I’m’er sister, miss.”, what does “meaningly” most nearly mean?
   A. to watch over and direct work
   B. something ugly that spoils a view
   C. in a way meant to suggest something unspoken
   D. cause to ripen or develop fully
8. As used in the story (“They were the greatest possible eyesore, and they had no right to be in that neighbourhood at all.”), what does “eyesore” mean?
   A. something ugly that spoils a view
   B. bend one's back forward from the waist on down
   C. a daily or weekly publication on folded sheets; contains news and articles and advertisements
   D. to watch over and direct work
9. As used in the story (“She said meaningly, “I’m’er sister, miss.”), what does “meaningly” mean?
   A. be in accord; be in agreement
   B. in a way meant to suggest something unspoken
   C. called on (someone)
   D. cause to ripen or develop fully
10. As used in the story (“But Meg could not possibly go and supervise the men.”), what does “supervise” mean?
    A. put into a proper or systematic order
    B. something ugly that spoils a view
    C. to watch over and direct work
    D. bend one's back forward from the waist on down
11. As used in the story (“And the perfect afternoon slowly ripened, slowly faded, slowly its petals closed.”), what does “ripened” mean?
    A. a daily or weekly publication on folded sheets; contains news and articles and advertisements
    B. in a way meant to suggest something unspoken
    C. be in accord; be in agreement
    D. cause to ripen or develop fully
12. As used in the story (“She crouched down as if to warm herself at that blaze of lilies; she felt they were in her fingers, on her lips, growing in her breast.”), what does “crouched” mean?
    A. bend one's back forward from the waist on down
    B. called on (someone)
    C. to watch over and direct work
    D. put into a proper or systematic order

## Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how class and privilege develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.
2. Explain how life and death develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.
3. Explain how coming of age develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.

## Part III: Essay

Choose one of the story's central concerns (class and privilege, life and death, coming of age) and argue how the ending reframes it.

## Answer key

**Answer key:** 1. B (A garden party); 2. A (A young carter, Mr. Scott); 3. D (Stop the party); 4. C (A basket of leftover food); 5. C (Forgive my hat); 6. B (something ugly that spoils a view); 7. C (in a way meant to suggest something unspoken); 8. A (something ugly that spoils a view); 9. B (in a way meant to suggest something unspoken); 10. C (to watch over and direct work); 11. D (cause to ripen or develop fully); 12. A (bend one's back forward from the waist on down)

# Essay assignments

## Essay: Class and privilege

**Middle School** (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Garden Party teaches about class and privilege. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Katherine Mansfield develops class and privilege in The Garden Party. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Katherine Mansfield develops class and privilege across The Garden Party. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Garden Party (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of class and privilege. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of class and privilege in The Garden Party. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Katherine Mansfield's choices in The Garden Party (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of class and privilege, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Garden Party's treatment of class and privilege in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on class and privilege in The Garden Party that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on class and privilege in The Garden Party. Name your critical

method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about class and privilege in The Garden Party, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on class and privilege in The Garden Party, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Life and death

**Middle School** (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Garden Party teaches about life and death. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Katherine Mansfield develops life and death in The Garden Party. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Katherine Mansfield develops life and death across The Garden Party. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Garden Party (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of life and death. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of life and death in The Garden Party. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Katherine Mansfield's choices in The Garden Party (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of life and death, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Garden Party's treatment of life and death in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on life and death in The Garden Party that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on life and death in The Garden Party. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about life and death in The Garden Party, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on life and death in The Garden Party, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Coming of age

**Middle School** (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Garden Party teaches about coming of age. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Katherine Mansfield develops coming of age in The Garden Party. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Katherine Mansfield develops coming of age across The Garden Party. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Garden Party (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of coming of age. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of coming of age in The Garden Party. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Katherine Mansfield's choices in The Garden Party (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of coming of age, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Garden Party's treatment of coming of age in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on coming of age in The Garden Party that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on coming of age in The Garden Party. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about coming of age in The Garden Party, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on coming of age in The Garden Party, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Original Liber et Libri curriculum. Quotations from the public-domain text. Vocabulary definitions are modern and contextual (curated; based on Princeton WordNet 3.0). Word histories appear only where verified (Online Etymology Dictionary, 2026-10-20); other words are student look-ups. AP and Cambridge entries are our own summaries with links, not College Board or Cambridge text; ICC-WC and LeL IDs are Liber et Libri labels. Included with every curriculum purchase and with Classroom Pro.